Self-Exercise: Bash Scripts and Automation

For a successful completion of the tasks, it is enough use just one machine. Perhaps, a new one.

Let's assume that the following list of tasks will be performed on **a new** virtual machine:

1. Create a script named **user-data.sh** that when started will ask the user for (without the a.,b.,c.):
   a. First name
   b. Last name
   c. Place of birth

   Then it will append the collected data to a file **/tmp/user-data.dat**. For example, if the user input is (without the a.,b.,c.):

   a. John
   b. Smith
   c. London

   The script will store **John;Smith;London** in the file.
2. Execute the script several times (**3 to 5**) with **different answers** each time
3. Create a script named **show-data.sh** that when started with a parameter **a file name** (the one from the previous exercise) will display the information from it in the following format (without the a.):
   a. Row #n: First;Last;Place where n is the record number

   For example (without the a.,b.,c.):

   a. Row #1: John;Smith;London
   b. Row #2: Jane;Hudson;Manchester
   c. …

   If executed **without** parameters or with **incorrect** number of parameters to **display** help **message** and **quit**.
4. Create a script named **archiver.sh** that will accept two parameters on the command line (without the a.,b.):
   a. Folder to archive
   b. Name (and path) of the resulting archive

   When **executed** with the **two parameters** to create a **tar+gz** archive. If executed with **incorrect number** of parameters or their **values** are **incorrect** (parameters should follow the rules):

   a. First parameter should be always an existing folder
   b. Second parameter should be non-existing file

   To display **help message** and to **exit**.

Self-Check

After you are done with the tasks, you can check how well you did them

In a terminal session execute one of the following commands (depending on which executable you have)

- Option 1 (**wget** installed, usually for **Debian**-based distributions)
  wget -q https://courses.zahariev.pro/m7.sh -O - | sudo bash
- Option 2 (**curl** installed, most of the distributions)
  curl -s https://courses.zahariev.pro/m7.sh | sudo bash

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Repeat the procedure until you get as much **PASS** marks as possible. This may include adjustments on what you did or even start from the beginning

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